UPI & Payment Fraud

Knowledge document for the AI Digital Safety & Scam Prevention Assistant

Core rule: Enter your UPI PIN only inside your trusted UPI app when you intentionally authorize a payment. Receiving money does not require entering a UPI PIN. Never share an OTP, UPI PIN, password, or card security code.

1. What is UPI and payment fraud?

UPI and payment fraud involves tricking a person into sending money, approving a payment, revealing credentials, or installing software that gives someone access to a device or account. Scams may use UPI apps, QR codes, payment links, fake customer-support accounts, messaging apps, phone calls, or false screenshots.

2. Common payment scam patterns

UPI collect / payment request

A person claims you must approve a collect request to receive a refund, prize, job payment, or money from a buyer. Read the request carefully. Approving it may authorize money to leave your account.

QR-code scam

A stranger asks you to scan a QR code and enter your UPI PIN to receive money. A QR code can be used to initiate a payment; do not enter your PIN unless you intend to pay the displayed recipient.

Fake payment screenshot

A buyer or caller shows an edited screenshot or says payment is pending. Check the transaction inside your own bank or UPI app; do not rely only on a screenshot, SMS, or email.

Fake customer support

A person posing as bank, wallet, or payment-app support asks for an OTP, PIN, screen sharing, remote-access app, or a small fee to reverse a payment. Contact support through the official app or website.

Suspicious payment link

A message asks you to open a link to receive a refund, verify a wallet, or unlock a payment. Avoid the link and verify independently using the official app or known website.

Urgent money request

A caller impersonates a relative, colleague, employer, or official and demands immediate payment. Verify through a separate trusted channel before transferring money.

3. Before approving a UPI payment

• Check whether the screen says you are paying or collecting/receiving. Read the exact wording and amount.

• Verify the recipient's name and details shown by your UPI app before authorizing a payment.

• Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, password, card PIN, CVV, or recovery code with another person, including someone claiming to be support staff.

• Do not install remote-access or screen-sharing apps at the request of an unknown caller.

• Do not trust payment screenshots alone. Confirm the credit in your own bank or payment app.

• When in doubt, cancel the request and contact the bank or payment provider using official contact details.

4. If you think a payment request is fraudulent

• Do not approve it, enter your PIN, or follow the link.

• Take a screenshot of the request and note the sender, date, amount, and any transaction or reference ID, while keeping credentials private.

• Report the account, message, or request through the payment app's official reporting option if available.

• Contact your bank or payment provider through its official app, website, or verified number if your account may be at risk.

5. If money has already been sent or an account is compromised

• Contact your bank and payment provider immediately and ask them to register the fraud report and advise on securing the account. Quick reporting may help, but recovery is not guaranteed.

• In India, report suspected financial cyber fraud by calling 1930 as soon as possible and submit the complaint through https://cybercrime.gov.in/ as instructed by the helpline/portal.

• Preserve transaction IDs, bank statements, screenshots, phone numbers, messages, links, and timestamps. Do not pay anyone who promises guaranteed recovery for an advance fee.

• If you shared credentials, change them through the genuine service's official app or website and secure any other accounts where the same password was reused.

• Do not delete evidence before saving it. Follow your bank's and official authorities' instructions.

6. Example scenarios

Scenario A: A stranger says, “Scan this QR and enter your PIN to receive your refund.” **Safer response:** Do not proceed. Receiving money should not require you to enter your UPI PIN to authorize an outgoing payment.

Scenario B: A buyer sends a payment screenshot but the money is not visible in your account. **Safer response:** Do not hand over goods or send money back based only on the screenshot. Verify the credit in your own bank/payment app.

Scenario C: Someone claiming to be customer support asks for your OTP or screen sharing. **Safer response:** Stop the interaction and contact the provider through the official app or website.

7. What the AI assistant can and cannot conclude

The assistant can explain common scam patterns and suggest verification steps. It cannot confirm that a payment request, QR code, phone number, recipient, or screenshot is genuine from a text description alone. Always verify inside the official payment app and contact your bank or provider when uncertain.

8. Official reference sources

• **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI):** https://www.npci.org.in/

• **Reserve Bank of India (RBI):** https://www.rbi.org.in/

• **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** https://cybercrime.gov.in/

• **CERT-In Awareness Booklets:** https://www.cert-in.org.in/AwarenessBooklets.jsp

Maintenance note: Educational summary for a prototype knowledge base. Verify current official guidance and reporting procedures periodically. Last reviewed: 10 October 2026.